

SFA Market Context and Audiences

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1. The Market: Israel's Organic and Small-Farm Sector

1.1 Landscape Overview

Israel has a small but active organic and small-scale farming community. It includes professional market gardeners (חקלאי שוק) who grow vegetables and herbs for direct sale at farmers' markets and through community-supported agriculture (CSA) boxes, home and community gardeners who grow food at a larger-than-hobby scale, and a broader community of learners, students, and food-sovereignty advocates.

The Israeli organic sector is characterized by:

- A small number of certified organic producers relative to the total agricultural base.
- Strong grassroots interest in sustainable, low-input, and regenerative growing methods, partly fueled by the global market-gardening movement popularized by Jean-Martin Fortier (JMF).
- Limited availability of localized, Hebrew-language agronomic reference material. Most internationally recognized market-gardening resources (Fortier's MasterClass, Tend software, Curtis Stone's guides) are in English and not calibrated to Israeli growing conditions, climate zones, or Hebrew crop nomenclature.
- A fragmented price-information landscape. Organic and specialty-produce prices in Israel are not systematically published. There is no open, community-maintained reference for what organic vegetables actually sell for at farmers' markets or farm gates.
- Community-building activity happening in dispersed channels (WhatsApp groups, Facebook communities), without a shared data commons.

1.2 Core Problems SFA Addresses

Problem	Why It Matters	SFA's Response
Fragmented agronomic knowledge	Market gardeners and home growers lack a single, localized, Hebrew-language reference for crop planning. JMF and other trusted sources are English-only and not calibrated to Israeli conditions, varieties, and seasons.	The Crop Book (ספר גידולים) — a structured, multi-source agronomic knowledge base for 66 crops, localized to Israel.
No transparent organic price reference	Producers and buyers have no open benchmark for organic vegetable prices. This disadvantages small producers who cannot negotiate from a shared data baseline.	The Market Index (מחירון שוק) — a community organic price index aggregated from multiple retail and farm sources, published openly with provenance.
Manual, error-prone planning	Bed allocation, succession scheduling, seed ordering, and revenue estimation are done ad	Crop Book calculators — 14 deterministic planning tools feeding from agronomic data

Problem	Why It Matters	SFA's Response
	hoc — in spreadsheets or from memory. Errors compound across a season.	(yield, spacing, germination rates) so each calculation inherits real crop knowledge.
Sign-up walls and paywalls	Most digital farm-management tools require registration and charge subscription fees, which creates friction for small and beginning farmers who may not be ready to commit.	Open, no-signup, free-core posture — every public tool is accessible without an account.
Israel-specific blind spots	International tools do not include Israeli sources, Hebrew plant names, local calendar conventions, or Israeli agricultural extension data.	Multi-source enrichment: the Israeli Ministry of Agriculture (MoA / מ"מ), Shaham bulletins, Idan planning guides, Bustan calendar, and Tend Israel operational data are all integrated alongside the international JMF/MasterClass baseline.

2. Positioning Statement

SmallFarmsAgents (sfa.nimrod.bio) is an open, community platform offering free agronomic knowledge and planning tools for Israel's small-farm and organic-growing community — Hebrew-first, no signup required, built on provenance-tracked data from the sources growers already trust.

Short form: כלים פתוחים לחקלאות קטנה ("Open tools for small-scale farming")

3. Differentiators

Differentiator	What It Means in Practice
Open and free core	The Crop Book, calculators, and Market Index are fully accessible without an account or payment. No freemium gate on core agronomic functions.
Provenance-backed data	Every data point has a source class (EX expert / NI curated / PR published / OP operational / MK market / WB web) and a confidence tier. Users can see where a value comes from. The reconciler blends multiple sources into a single best estimate — it does not just show raw scraped data.
Israel-localized	Hebrew crop names, Israeli seasons, Israeli MoA and Shaham extension data, local market prices, and the Tend Israel operational overlay. Not a translation of an English tool.
Two-audience UX	The Crop Book is designed for both the gardener audience (card view — approachable, visual) and the market-farmer/table-farmer audience (table view — dense, comparative). Calculators expose simple and full depth levels.
Calculator math tied to crop data	The 14 planning calculators do not use generic defaults — each draws from the crop_field_enrichment best-estimate values for the specific crop being planned.
Community price index	The Market Index is not a single retailer's price list. It aggregates from four MyPIPS community sources and normalizes by product and unit. Updated daily.
No lock-in	No account, no data collection beyond aggregate analytics, no vendor relationship required.

4. Audience Map

4.1 Market Farmers (חקלאי שוק)

Profile: Professional or semi-professional growers selling at farmers' markets (שוק אורגני), through CSA boxes, or wholesale. Typically 0.1–2 hectares under cultivation. Many use raised-bed systems inspired by the market-gardening method.

Needs: - Agronomic planning data calibrated to their scale and crop mix. - Succession scheduling (when to sow the next batch so supply is continuous). - Yield estimation, bed allocation, and revenue projection for seasonal planning. - Price reference to set competitive and fair prices. - Variety selection guidance anchored to local performance data.

How SFA Serves Them: - Crop Book table view shows all agronomic parameters side-by-side across crops — useful for planning crop mix and rotation. - Calculators include succession scheduling (#6), beds-for-target-yield (#7), seed quantity (#1–#3), transplant timing (#4–#5), plant population (#10), and revenue/profit comparison (#9, #13, #14). - Market Index gives weekly community price benchmarks for organic produce. - Tend operational overlay (OP-class data) feeds real Israeli farm performance data back into the enrichment layer.

Messaging Hook: "Plan your season from real data, not guesses — crop spacing, succession timing, and revenue estimates all drawn from what Israeli market gardeners actually grow."

4.2 Home and Market Gardeners (גננים)

Profile: Home gardeners at the ambitious end of the spectrum — growing seriously for household food, sharing with neighbors, or exploring small-scale farming. May be transitioning toward market-farming. Often follow JMF or permaculture methods.

Needs: - Accessible, Hebrew-language guidance on crop planning basics. - Germination rates, spacing, days-to-maturity, and season windows for common vegetables. - Simple tools that don't require agronomic expertise to use. - Visual, approachable presentation.

How SFA Serves Them: - Crop Book card view presents each crop's key parameters visually, with a simple/full depth toggle. - AssumptionField pattern makes calculators usable without expert knowledge — sensible defaults (germination rate 90%, bed width 80 cm) are shown openly and can be adjusted. - The Crop Book covers 66 crops with localized Hebrew names and variety information. - Questions section explains planning concepts in plain language.

Messaging Hook: "Everything you need to plan a successful vegetable garden — in Hebrew, without registering, without paying."

4.3 Learners and Students (לומדים וסטודנטים)

Profile: Agricultural students, permaculture-course participants, aspiring market gardeners researching the profession, researchers studying the Israeli organic sector.

Needs: - Reliable, citable reference data for crops. - Understanding of how organic price indices work. - Access to methodology and data provenance (not just results).

How SFA Serves Them: - The Crop Book exposes provenance cues — VALIDATED / PARTIAL / INFERRED badges signal data confidence. - Source classes (EX / NI / PR / OP / MK / WB) are documented and visible. - Market Index includes methodology transparency (community sources listed, confidence thresholds explained). - The platform's data model is rigorous: multi-source reconciliation, outlier gates (MAD-based), $\tau=0.40$ validation threshold — appropriate for citation in academic or professional contexts.

Messaging Hook: "Agronomic data with provenance — not just numbers, but numbers you can trace."

4.4 Community Contributors

Profile: Growers, researchers, and enthusiasts who want to contribute local knowledge, price observations, or variety data to the commons.

Needs: - A safe, low-friction way to share what they know. - Confidence that their contributions are handled with data discipline (not just added as noise). - Recognition that their contribution improves the commons.

How SFA Serves Them: - The /contribute endpoint is available (currently a submit-your-knowledge form — community write-back is a planned feature, not yet live as a structured two-way loop). - The community feed section surfaces community activity. - Future Tend integration (CB-5, planned) will create a formal operational write-back path from farm records.

Messaging Hook: "Your farm knowledge belongs in a shared commons — contribute and help build the most localized organic farming dataset in Israel."

4.5 Business Partners

Profile: Agricultural input suppliers, seed companies, farm-management software vendors, CSA-box platforms, agricultural extension organizations, and investment/grant bodies interested in the Israeli organic food system.

Needs: - Understanding of the platform's data quality and reach. - Clarity on the business model and partnership opportunities. - Proof that the platform serves a real, engaged community.

How SFA Serves Them: - Market Index gives suppliers and buyers a shared price reference. - Crop Book is a canonical data asset — extensible as a vendor product catalog or agronomic advice layer. - Open/free-core model creates a large, unregistered audience that can be a channel for partner visibility. - Data model is API-capable — the ingest pipeline is HMAC-signed, structured, and deployable as a partner data feed.

Messaging Hook: "The only open, provenance-tracked organic produce price index in Israel — built on community sources with daily updates and a transparent methodology."

5. Competitive and Category Context

SFA does not compete directly with any single Israeli product. Its closest category peers are:

Comparator	Category	Gap SFA Fills
Tend (international)	Farm management software	Israel-localized knowledge layer; open/free-core; no signup barrier
JMF MasterClass	English-language agronomic education	Hebrew; Israel-specific; interactive calculators
Israeli MoA publications (שה"מ)	Official extension data	Consumer-friendly UX; combined with private-sector sources; continuously updated
Generic price scraping services	Price data	Community provenance; agricultural normalization; Hebrew nomenclature
Spreadsheet-based planning	Farm planning	Pre-populated with crop data; succession/yield logic built in

SFA occupies a unique white space: open community infrastructure for small-farm knowledge in Israel.

6. Platform Posture Summary

Attribute	Value
Registration required	No — fully open
Core tools free	Yes
Language	Hebrew-first; English in code and documentation
Data provenance	Always visible — source class + confidence tier
Update frequency	Market Index: daily (automated pipeline). Crop Book: continuous enrichment from new sources.
Hosting	sfa.nimrod.bio (uPress, Cloudflare edge)
Community stance	Open commons — no paywalls, no lock-in